

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Billing Dispute Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

Document ID	AW-BIL-010
Version	2.0
Last Updated	August 2026
Department	Finance Operations
Company	Aether Wireless
Classification	Internal — Training & Reference

Overview

This policy outlines the procedures customers must follow to contest charges on their Aether Wireless invoices. It establishes clear timelines, required information, and resolution processes to ensure fair and efficient handling of billing disputes. All customers have the right to dispute any charge they believe is inaccurate, unauthorized, or erroneous. Aether Wireless commits to investigating all valid disputes within defined service level agreements while protecting customers from late fees during the review period.

Filing a Billing Dispute

Eligibility Window

Customers must submit billing disputes within **60 calendar days** of the invoice date appearing on their billing statement. Disputes submitted after this window may be denied unless exceptional circumstances apply, such as documented fraud or identity theft.

- The invoice date is the date the billing statement was generated, not the payment due date
- The 60-day window is calculated from the invoice date to the date the dispute is received by Aether Wireless
- Customers are encouraged to file disputes as soon as they identify a questionable charge

Required Information

To process a billing dispute, customers must provide the following information:

Required Field	Description
Invoice Number	The unique identifier found on the billing statement containing the disputed charge
Disputed Amount	The specific dollar amount being contested
Reason for Dispute	A clear explanation of why the charge is believed to be incorrect or unauthorized

Additional supporting documentation may strengthen a dispute and expedite resolution, such as:

- Copies of receipts or contracts

- Correspondence related to the charge
- Details of any prior verbal or written agreements

Filing Channels

Customers may submit billing disputes through any of the following channels:

1. **Mobile App** – Log in to the Aether Wireless app, navigate to Account > Billing > Dispute a Charge
2. **Online Portal** – Visit aetherwireless.com, sign in to My Account, and access the billing dispute form
3. **Phone** – Call Customer Care at 1-800-AETHER-1 (1-800-234-8371)
4. **In-Store** – Visit any authorized Aether Wireless retail location

All channels provide immediate confirmation of dispute receipt and issue a case number for tracking.

Dispute Investigation Process

Initial Review

Upon receiving a dispute, Aether Wireless performs an initial validation within **2 business days** to ensure the dispute contains all required information. If information is missing, the customer is contacted to provide the necessary details.

The investigation then examines:

- Service usage records and call detail logs
- Contract terms and applicable rate plans
- Payment history and account status
- Any prior communications regarding the disputed charge

Investigation Timeline

Aether Wireless aims to complete its investigation within **5 business days** of receiving a complete dispute. During this period:

- Account notes are updated daily with investigation status
- Internal teams coordinate to verify charge accuracy
- External partners (such as roaming providers) may be consulted when applicable

If the investigation requires additional time beyond 5 business days, the customer receives written notification explaining the reason for the delay and an updated expected resolution date.

Resolution and Credit

Once the investigation is complete, the customer receives written notification of the outcome:

- **Validated Error** – If the dispute is upheld, a credit is issued to the customer's account within **5 business days** of the decision. The credit appears on the next available billing statement.
- **Charge Upheld** – If the investigation confirms the charge is valid, the customer receives a detailed explanation and any supporting documentation.

Billing Holds and Late Fees

During the dispute investigation period:

- The disputed amount is **placed on hold** and excluded from the customer's payment due calculation
- **No late fees or service interruptions** will be applied to the disputed amount while the case is under active review
- Customers remain responsible for paying any undisputed portions of their invoice by the due date

If the dispute is resolved and the charge is upheld, the hold is released and standard billing terms apply moving forward.

Customer Communication

Case Numbers

Every billing dispute is assigned a unique **case number** at the time of filing. Customers should reference this case number in all follow-up communications. The case number allows customer service representatives to quickly retrieve the full dispute history and status.

Resolution Timeline

At the time of filing, customers receive an **estimated resolution timeline** based on the complexity of the dispute. This estimate is communicated verbally (phone/in-store) and in writing (email/SMS confirmation). Customers are notified within 24 hours of any changes to the expected timeline.

Duplicate Disputes

If a customer submits multiple disputes for the same charge through different channels:

- The most recent complete dispute supersedes any earlier submissions
- Duplicate disputes filed within 7 days of the original submission are consolidated into the existing case
- Customers are notified when a duplicate dispute is identified and merged

Customers must not file duplicate disputes to expedite processing, as this may delay overall resolution.

External Escalation

Regulator Escalation Timeline

If a billing dispute remains **unresolved after 30 calendar days**, customers may escalate the matter to external authorities:

- **Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB)** – Submit a complaint at consumerfinance.gov
- **State Regulatory Agency** – Contact the state public utility commission or attorney general's consumer protection division

Aether Wireless cooperates fully with all regulatory inquiries and provides documentation upon request. Escalation to a regulator does not preclude the customer from pursuing other remedies available under applicable law.

FAQs

Q: Can I dispute a charge that is older than 60 days?

A: Generally, no. The 60-day filing window is designed to ensure accurate record retention and timely resolution. However, disputes involving fraud, identity theft, or unauthorized charges may be considered outside this window. Contact Customer Care to discuss your specific situation.

Q: Will my service be disconnected while my dispute is being investigated?

A: No. Aether Wireless does not disconnect service or report late payment to credit bureaus for amounts under active dispute review. You must continue paying any undisputed balances to avoid interruption on those services.

Q: How will I be notified of the dispute outcome?

A: You will receive written notification via email and/or SMS within 5 business days of the decision. The notification includes the case number, resolution details, and any credit issued.

Q: What happens if the investigation takes longer than expected?

A: If the investigation exceeds 5 business days, you will receive an update notification explaining the delay and providing a new estimated resolution date. You may also check the status anytime through the mobile app or online portal using your case number.

Q: Can I escalate my dispute if I disagree with the outcome?

A: Yes. If you disagree with the resolution, you may request a supervisor review within 14 days of the decision. After exhausting internal options, you may escalate to the CFPB or your state regulator after 30 days if the matter remains unresolved.

Q: What if the disputed charge was for a roaming service I did not use?

A: Roaming disputes are handled the same as other charges. Provide as much detail as possible about your location during the billing period. Aether Wireless will review usage records and coordinate with roaming partners to verify the charge.

For questions about this policy, contact Customer Care at 1-800-AETHER-1 or visit your nearest Aether Wireless retail location.